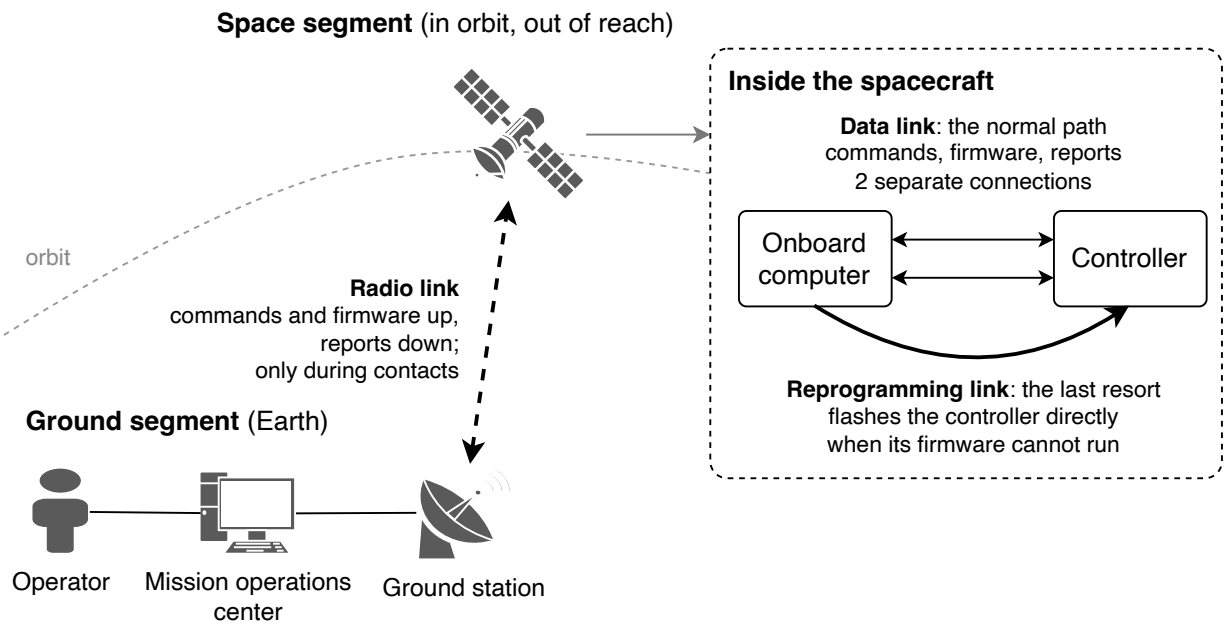
Space segment (in orbit, out of reach)
orbit
Radio link
commands and firmware up,
reports down;
only during contacts
Ground segment (Earth)
Operator
Mission operations center
Ground station
Inside the spacecraft
Data link: the normal path
commands, firmware, reports
2 separate connections
Onboard computer
Controller
Reprogramming link: the last resort
flashes the controller directly
when its firmware cannot run